i. Which stage of life is being referred to here by the poet?

ii. What are the characteristics of this stage?

iii. How does the boy go to school?

iv. Which figure of speech has been employed in the second line?

b) *Then a soldier,*
full of strange oaths, and bearded like the pard,
Jealous in honour, sudden and quick in quarrel,
Seeking the bubble reputation
Even in the cannon's mouth.

i. What is the soldier ready to do?

ii. Explain 'bubble reputation'.

iii. What are the distinguishing features of this stage?

c) *And then the justice,*
In fair round belly with good capon lin'd,
With eyes severe and beard of formal cut,
Full of wise saws and modern instances;

i. Whom does justice refer to?

ii. Describe his appearance.

iii. How does he behave with the people around him?

iv. What does he do to show his wisdom?

7. Complete the table based on your understanding of the poem.

Stage	Characteristic
	crying
judge	
soldier	
	unhappy
second childhood	
	whining
old man	

8. Based on your understanding of the poem, answer the following questions in about 100 – 150 words each. You may add your own ideas if required, to present and justify your point of view.

a) Describe the various stages of a man's life picturised in the poem "All the World's a stage."

b) Shakespeare has skilfully brought out the parallels between the life of man and actors on stage. Elaborate this statement with reference to the poem.

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